

BUDGET DAY
UP CM Yogi Adityanath, finance minister Suresh Khanna (with Budget papers) and others, May 26

UTTAR PRADESH

YOGI SHOWS SOME INDUSTRY

By Prashant Srivastava

The Yogi Adityanath government's long-held dream of making Uttar Pradesh an industrial powerhouse gets another boost on June 3 with *'bhoomi poojan'* being done for some 2,000 projects worth Rs 75,000 crore. Prime Minister Narendra Modi will be the chief guest at what is the third 'ground-breaking ceremony' (GBC-3) in the past five years. Some 60 top industrialists have reportedly confirmed attendance, including Kumar Mangalam Birla, Gautam Adani, Sajjan Jindal and many others.

In 2018, the Yogi government had held its first Uttar Pradesh Investors Summit in Lucknow where proposals for investment of Rs 4.68 lakh crore were received. Government figures claim that projects worth Rs 3 lakh crore have been realised on the ground from the two GBCs—in 2018 and 2019—in Yogi's first tenure. PM Modi will also inaugurate an exhibition, which will have stalls showcasing products of 12 start-ups and 14 other investors. The 'one district-one product' (ODOP) scheme is also putting up 60-odd stalls.

An industries department official says 865 MSME (medium, small and micro enterprises) projects worth Rs 3,586 crore will be rolled out at the event. Of these, 283 units will come up in Meerut, followed by temple town Ayodhya with 128 units. Some 14,000 new jobs are expected to open up in the Meerut region.

According to officials, of the projects launched at the event, Rs 21,000 crore will come in the information technology (IT) and electronics sectors. Among these are the data centres of the Adani (Rs 4,900 crore) and Hiranandani (Rs 9,100 crore) groups and a Rs 2,100 crore software development centre of Microsoft. In manufacturing, work on a Rs 600 crore cement plant by the Dalmia Group in Mirzapur and a detergent plant of Hindustan Unilever will also begin. Other projects